



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Arcadia Christian School

School Website: <https://arcadiachristianschool.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Arcadia Christian School (ACS)

Executive Summary TL;DR - Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (transitioning to more fully classical). - Why: ACS publicly affirms a theological foundation ("Scripture at every point is the foundation on which to build all knowledge," with "biblical worldview in all subjects") and adopts core classical structures and methods (Schools of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; memorization; Socratic discussion). Evidence for Great Books, Latin/classical languages, chant/singing, wonder/scholé, and liturgical school practices is not (yet) explicit on public pages reviewed.

- Strongest areas: Religious/Theological foundations; Pedagogy; Parent partnership.
- Biggest gaps to become unmistakably classical: Publish Great Books lists; show Latin (or Greek) and quadrivium elements; make lower-school chant/recitation visible; foreground "truth, goodness, beauty" and "wonder/scholé"; describe chapel/liturgical life; post a public "portrait of a teacher/graduate."

Method and framework - Sources: ACS's public site content from the provided crawl (notably the "ACS Classical Education Method" and "Moment with Mr. Limon" pages; program pages for Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; Bible curriculum/parent partnership language).

- Rubric: The Six Essential Elements/keyword indicators (positive/negative) and classicality lexicon were used as the scoring framework (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community).

SECTION 1 — RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Keyword analysis (from ACS site) - Direct matches/evidence: - "Scripture at every point is the foundation on which to build all knowledge... continuing to teach from a biblical worldview in all subjects" (Scripture, biblical worldview, theology-integration) - "Purpose... to teach the Word of God... in cooperation with their parents/guardians" (Word of God; theological centrality) - Formation aim: "training and equipping them in faith, character, heart, and service" (formation language) - Comparison to Positive/Negative indicators: - Positive matches to framework keywords: sacred scripture; Christian worldview; Christ-centered formation; theology-informed curriculum (positive list: theology, sacred scripture, faith and reason, Christian formation) - Missing/low-evidence: explicit "truth, goodness, beauty"; liturgical/communal practice terms (chapel, worship, prayer, liturgy) not observed in crawl snippets. - No negative signals seen (e.g., "values-neutral," "secular/nonsectarian"). - Quantitative estimate: - Positive keyword hits (unique): 4 (Scripture, biblical worldview, Word of God, Christian/Christ-followers/formation); Negative: 0; Liturgical terms: 0 observed. Approx. 80–100% of matched signals are positive, with a gap in liturgical language coverage. - Category rating: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Clear theological grounding and formation language meet most criteria for this category, even though explicit liturgical/chapel language is not yet evident.

SECTION 2 — SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Keyword analysis (from ACS site) - Direct matches/evidence: - "Teach our students not what to think, but how to think!" (intellectual formation over mere information) - Formation language: "faith, character, heart, and service" (virtue/formation emphasis; though "virtue" and "wisdom" not named explicitly) - "Partner... in training and equipping our students to be Christ followers" (formation telos) - Comparison to Positive/Negative indicators: - Positives sought: virtue, wisdom, formation, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty (TGB). ACS uses

“how to think,” “character,” “faith,” “formation/ equip,” but does not explicitly state TGB or “wisdom/virtue.” - No “college-and-career-ready/21st century skills/workforce prep” emphasis seen (negative list). - Quantitative estimate: - Positive keyword hits (unique): 3–4 (“how to think,” faith, character, equip/train); Negative: 0; Missing: explicit “virtue,” “wisdom,” “truth, goodness, beauty,” “scholé.” Estimate ≈ 70–80% of desired purpose-language present. - Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Rationale: Clear formation posture and how-to-think emphasis; would be strengthened by explicit statements about cultivating wisdom/virtue and pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty.

SECTION 3 — CURRICULUM

Keyword analysis (from ACS site) - Direct matches/evidence: - Trivium structure is explicit on program pages: “School of Grammar: K–5,” “School of Logic: 6–8,” “School of Rhetoric: 9–12” (grammar, logic, rhetoric). - “Reading in the classics” + “student engagement around Socratic discussion” (classics/Great Books direction; Socratic texts) - Bible curriculum (explicit academic integration of theology) - Comparison to Positive/Negative indicators: - Positives matched: Trivium; classics/Great Books orientation; Socratic texts. - Missing/low-evidence: Latin/Greek or quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) named explicitly; formal Great Books reading lists; “history” (vs. “social studies”) explicitly stated. No negative terms like “social studies replacing history,” “STEM-first,” or “project-based dominance” observed. - Quantitative estimate: - Positive keyword hits (unique): 5 (grammar, logic, rhetoric, classics, Socratic); Negative: 0; Missing: quadrivium, Latin/Greek, Great Books lists. Estimate ≈ 65–75% of the core curriculum indicators observed publicly. - Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Rationale: Strong Trivium structure and classics/Socratic signals; needs explicit Latin/Greek or quadrivium language and published Great Books/history sequences for a clear “CLASSICAL” mark.

SECTION 4 — PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

Keyword analysis (from ACS site) - Direct matches/evidence: - “Memorization—grammar stage; argument—logic stage; analysis and expression—rhetoric stage.” (lower-school memory; upper-school dialectic/rhetoric) - “Student engagement around Socratic discussion” (Socratic/seminar) - Comparison to Positive/Negative indicators: - Positives matched: memorization/recitation; Socratic/dialectic; rhetoric emphasis (speaking/expression). Restful learning/scholé, chanting/singing, and wonder language not yet explicit in the crawl. No progressive-only pedagogy (project-based dominance, constructivist/student-directed) language found. - Quantitative estimate: - Positive keyword hits (unique): 3–4 (memorization, Socratic, grammar/logic/rhetoric staging); Negative: 0; Missing: scholé/rest, chant/singing, wonder. Estimate ≈ 75–85% of core classical pedagogy indicators present. - Category rating: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Clear commitment to trivium-aligned pedagogy and Socratic practice; adding public evidence of lower-school chant/recitation and stated scholé/wonder would further strengthen.

SECTION 5 — FACULTY

Keyword analysis (from ACS site) - Direct matches/evidence: - “A unified faculty whose gift is to teach and speak to the heart of their students... The goal of our ACS faculty is to help nurture these gifts... always pointing to the One who gave those gifts” (virtue modeling/mentorship direction) - Comparison to Positive/Negative indicators: - Positives sought: teachers as models of virtue; mentors; living curriculum; collegial culture; explicit “portrait of a teacher/graduate.” ACS signals a mentoring posture and moral/spiritual modeling, but does not (yet) publish a teacher/graduate portrait or classical-formation commitments for faculty. - Quantitative estimate: - Positive keyword hits (unique): 2–3 (faculty unity, nurture, pointing to Christ/virtue modeling); Negative: 0; Missing: public “portrait of a teacher,” faculty formation in classical pedagogy. Estimate ≈ 60–70%. - Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Rationale: Faculty described as forming hearts and character toward Christ; codifying a public portrait of the classical teacher and faculty-formation practices would lift this to “CLASSICAL.”

SECTION 6 — PARENTS & COMMUNITY

Keyword analysis (from ACS site) - Direct matches/evidence: - Founders’ purpose includes education “in cooperation with their parents/and guardians.” - “Partner with us... in training and equipping our students to be Christ followers.” (explicit parent partnership invitation) - “It is our desire to partner with our ACS parents...” (Bible curriculum/parent alignment language) - Comparison to Positive/Negative indicators: -

Positives matched: parent partnership/co-educators, community orientation. No “consumer” or parent-as-customer-only language noted. More public evidence of parent formation (book clubs/seminars) would strengthen. - Quantitative estimate: - Positive keyword hits (unique): 3 (cooperation/partnership with parents, explicit invitations); Negative: 0. Estimate ≈ 85–100%. - Category rating: CLASSICAL - Rationale: Clear, repeated parent partnership language consistent with classical community norms; adding visible parent-formation offerings would be even stronger.

Aggregate Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Scorecard snapshot:
 - Religious/Metaphysical: CLASSICAL
 - Purpose & Goal: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
 - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL
- Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (strong movement toward fully CLASSICAL as of 2024–25). ACS publicly notes “ACS Journey towards Christian Classical Education” and the implementation of the “ACS Classical Education Method,” signaling an active transition.

What would move the needle (to secure a full CLASSICAL designation) - Name the transcendentals: Publish an explicit purpose statement affirming the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, along with the cultivation of wisdom and virtue, and “formation not information.” - Show the classical curriculum: Post Great Books reading lists by grade and the history sequence (explicitly “History” rather than “Social Studies”); highlight classical languages (at least Latin) and quadrivium elements.

- Make pedagogy visible: Describe lower-school chanting/singing/recitation routines; name scholé/restful learning and wonder as pedagogical commitments. - Liturgical school life: Publicize school-wide rhythms of prayer, chapel/worship, hymnody, or liturgical seasons to reflect theological formation as a communal practice. - Faculty formation: Publish a “Portrait of a Classical Teacher” and note ongoing faculty training in classical pedagogy; add a “Portrait of a Graduate.” - Parent formation: Offer and publicize parent book groups/seminars on classical education to deepen the home–school partnership.

Appendix: Keyword bases used for scoring - Religious/Metaphysical positives: sacred scripture, theology, Christian worldview, liturgy/chapel/worship (ACS: Scripture, biblical worldview present; chapel/liturgy not evidenced). - Purpose/Goal positives: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth/goodness/beauty, scholé (ACS: formation/how to think present; TGB/scholé absent). - Curriculum positives: Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Latin/Greek, integrated history, wonder (ACS: Trivium, classics, Socratic present; Latin/quadrivium/Great Books lists not yet visible). - Pedagogy positives: memorization/recitation/chanting; Socratic; rhetoric exercises; scholé/wonder (ACS: memorization, Socratic, trivium staging present; chanting/scholé/wonder not yet visible). - Faculty positives: teachers as moral exemplars/mentors; collegial culture; portraits (ACS: mentoring/formation language present; portraits/training not public). - Parents & Community positives: parent partnership, formation, hospitality (ACS: strong partnership language; parent formation opportunities not yet highlighted).

Selected evidence excerpts (from ACS site) - “Scripture at every point is the foundation on which to build all knowledge... biblical worldview in all subjects... implement reading in the classics and student engagement around Socratic discussion... memorization—grammar... argument—logic... analysis and expression—rhetoric.” - “School of Grammar... School of Logic... School of Rhetoric...” (program structure) - “Purpose... to teach the Word of God... in cooperation with their parents/guardians... partner with us... training and equipping our students to be Christ followers.” - “ACS Bible Curriculum in partnership with Summit Ministries... It is our desire to partner with our ACS parents...”

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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